

Question 49 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

A department is experiencing repeated performance errors. Apply the concept of TNA to identify what information should be collected before designing training.

Introduction

This is an application of Training Needs Assessment. The department wants fewer errors. A beginner's mistake is to announce a workshop on 'quality' immediately. TNA says: collect information first to decide whether training is the answer, who needs it, and what exactly must be learned. Use the three analyses — organisation, task, person — and the notes' warning that training is not the answer to all problems.

Write the answer as a list of information to collect, with why each item matters. That is what 'apply TNA' means.

Detailed points

- 1. Error facts, not opinions.** Collect type of error, frequency, process step, shift, product, cost, and whether errors cluster on certain days or machines. Use records plus observation, not only the supervisor's anger. Without facts, TNA is gossip and design will be guesswork.
- 2. Organisation-analysis information.** Department goals and quality standards; recent changes (new machine, new target, new software); staffing levels; whether speed is rewarded more than accuracy; whether supervisors actually support the correct method. Strategy link: is this error hurting customers or safety enough to be a priority?
- 3. Non-training causes — the most important TNA question.** Machine condition, missing tools, unclear or conflicting SOPs, impossible workload, incentive to rush, bad raw material. If these dominate, design a process or resource fix, not a course. The notes say apply cause-and-effect analysis before deciding that training is the answer. Write this boldly; it shows HRD maturity.
- 4. Task-analysis information.** The correct procedure step by step; which steps are critical; knowledge, skills and attitudes required; safety points; where in the task errors actually occur. This information becomes content if training is justified.
- 5. Person-analysis information.** Who makes the errors — new joiners, one shift, everyone? Previous training history. Can they explain the correct method (knowledge) but still fail (skill or attitude or pressure)? Language and literacy. Difference between 'does not know' and 'knows but does not do'.
- 6. Learner readiness and motivation.** Do employees believe errors matter? Are they afraid to report near-misses? Will they be punished for slowing down to be correct? If fear is high, climate work is needed along with or instead of skill training.
- 7. Transfer-climate information.** After a possible course, will the boss allow slower correct practice? Do peers mock the official method? Is the old informal shortcut still the way to hit targets? If transfer climate is hostile, even perfect design will not reduce errors.
- 8. Baseline for later evaluation.** Current error rate, customer complaints, rework cost. Agree what reduction in 8–12 weeks would mean success. Collecting this now is part of TNA, not something to invent after the programme. Without baseline, nobody can evaluate.

Conclusion. Before designing training, collect: error data, organisation context, non-training causes, task KSAs, person gaps, readiness, transfer climate, and a baseline. Only if the gap is largely a KSA gap should you design training. That is applied TNA, not a reflex workshop.